FOSTERING TRANSFORMATION THROUGH EDUCATION



Mahbubul Hoque

Mahbubul Hoque, a visionary edupreneur and institution builder, hailing from a remote village of Assam, single-handedly created a revolution in the educational ecosystem and is trying to make North East India an education hub of the country as well as a preferred destination for the teaching-learning community across the globe. Presently, his institutions provide the best education at par with top-rung institutions nationwide. From a very humble beginning, he rose to eminence by dint of sheer hard work and dogged determination. His never-say-die attitude towards life and his free and indomitable spirit is the biggest strength behind his remarkable success as an educational icon.

In the realm of visionary leaders, one name shines brightly - Mahbubul Hoque, an edupreneur with a mission to develop rural India through institution building. He stands as the founder of a series of educational institutions, including the biggest and NAAC A grade university of the north-east- "University of Science and Technology Meghalaya". His belief in the potential of rural communities to uplift the nation has led him to establish all his educational ventures in remote areas, where 90 percent of his students come from rural villages.

He believes that the right vision, honesty, and hard work are the only way to succeed, and therefore in spite of extreme financial constraints, he started his entrepreneurial journey with just one computer, four students, and Rs 85 in his pocket in 2001, rejecting lucrative job offers to him. He assembled computers and sold them in the market to generate revenue for the promotion of a computer lab for the trainers.

His first venture was a Study Centre namely "Central IT College" which he started in the year 2001 in a rental house to offer tuition to four IGNOU students. It was just the beginning. In 2005 it became the second-largest largest study-centre of the Manipal Group in the whole country. He continued his struggle in the field of education and succeeded in achieving milestones one after another traversing several impediments to set up the institutions in Assam and then Meghalaya.



With the 'Missile Man' & Former President of India Dr APJ Abdul Kalam

To expand further with entrepreneurial zeal he set up a trust namely the Education Research and Development Foundation (ERDF) Guwahati in 2005 incorporating some of his colleagues as members. In a span of twenty-two years, Mahbubul Hoque has achieved remarkable feats. As the founder Chairman of ERDF, he has established a range of pioneering educational institutions, offering education from KG to PG to Ph.D. These include two CBSE-affiliated Senior Secondary Schools, one AICTE-approved Engineering College, two PCI-approved Pharmacy Colleges, one BCI-approved Law School, one AICTE-approved Business School, and one NCTE-approved B. Ed. College, one Women's College, and his most emerging project—the University of Science & Technology Meghalaya.

Mahbubul's journey took a significant turn when he approached the Government of Meghalaya to establish a university. Recognizing his passionate entrepreneurial spirit, the Meghalaya Government agreed, leading to the birth of the first private university in the North East region in 2011 which started with only six students but has since flourished, currently boasting an impressive enrolment of over 6,000 students across 22 departments and 60 courses. It holds the distinction of being the largest private university in the North East region with a diverse student population where 57% are girl students. He is striving to make USTM an A++ institution by 2026 and one of the most preferred destinations for the global teaching-learning community by 2030.



North Campus